



Good jobs,
great places



LEED

OECD Local
Employment and
Economic
Development
Programme





THE OECD LOCAL EMPLOYMENT AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT (LEED) PROGRAMME

Since 1982, LEED has been gathering policy makers and practitioners from around the world to identify, evaluate and disseminate promising approaches to local development – including policies to support local job creation, skills development, social inclusion and economic growth. LEED's work is steered by a committee of representatives from ministries of employment and labour, social affairs, economy, and regional development from OECD and non-OECD countries. Many local and regional governments also actively engage on projects with LEED. The Programme is housed in the OECD's Centre for Entrepreneurship, SMEs, Regions and Cities.

WHY OUR WORK MATTERS

National averages don't tell the whole story

Local economies and labour markets differ within countries and face different barriers to growth and development. Local communities have different economic, social, and cultural assets. National policies should recognise these differences, meet the needs of local communities and be informed by tangible evidence of “what works” and doesn't work at the local level to improve economic opportunity and quality of life.

Local voices contribute to more effective national policies

That is why we advise on how to better tailor national policies to different local realities, and work with regions and cities on their bottom-up initiatives. We translate cutting-edge research into concrete guidance on what works at the local level. Bringing together policies at all levels of government, along with civil society and the private sector, we develop integrated frameworks for local development and employment creation. We bring the local voice to OECD discussions and debates and create opportunities for local practitioners, social innovators, the private sector and civic leaders to exchange with international experts and peers.



OUR AREAS OF WORK

- ❖ Employment and skills
- ❖ Social economy and innovation
- ❖ Culture, creative sectors and global events
- ❖ Local economic development
- ❖ The OECD Trento Centre for Local Development
- ❖ The OECD Local Development Forum



HOW TO GET INVOLVED

Access our online resources

- Use free online self-assessment tools to assess your local actions in an international context
- Access data to compare your community to others globally
- See how your local policies stack up against good practice

Attend or host events

- Be inspired by local success stories and innovative actions from communities all over the world
- Showcase your innovative practices to an international audience
- Become an OECD Local Development Forum partner

Participate in capacity building

- Develop practical skills and tools that you can immediately apply to your daily work
- Make lasting connections with an international network of policy makers and practitioners
- Share your expertise and unique experience with peers

Get tailored policy advice for your country, region or city

- Take stock of your local economic, social and cultural assets – and how to make the most of them
- Brainstorm ideas and innovative solutions with peer reviewers and international experts
- Receive practical recommendations for policy development and reforms



HOW WE CAN HELP YOU

Employment and skills

Creating quality job opportunities for everyone, everywhere



Climate change and emerging digital technologies are driving fundamental shifts in demand for talent and skills. In some OECD regions, as many as 30% of jobs already require green tasks, reflecting a growing imperative for sustainability. In many OECD regions, the share of hard-to-fill vacancies for jobs requiring ICT specialist skills has doubled on average in the last decade. Yet more action is needed to boost adult learning and skills development: only two in five adults across the OECD participate in education and training in any given year. Many others may also struggle to remain in the job market or keep pace with the changes.

A skilled workforce is an essential tool for local economies to attract new talent and investment. In fast-changing labour markets, local employment and skills policies need to better connect employers with the talent they seek and prepare all people for the future of work shaped by technology and the green transition.

WHAT WE DO

Deliver tailored policy advice and guide reforms

Carry out reviews of how national policies can adapt to the needs of different local labour markets and align with local employers' demand – and develop practical roadmaps for reform

Conduct studies for your region and city, to find practical solutions to labour market needs

Identify opportunities to make employment and skills policies more inclusive to particular people and places

Gather innovative data and evidence

Boost labour market intelligence on the impact of automation, artificial intelligence (AI) and the green transition on local jobs and workforce skills

Understand how megatrends will shape the geography of jobs and skills

Translate trends into actionable insights for governments to prepare for future workforce transitions

Build communities of practice

Bring together cities, regions, public employment services, training providers and employers to share good practices

Disseminate good practices to “future proof” skills systems with upskilling and reskilling opportunities for all

Showcase local skills systems which meet the needs of employers, adopt skills-based practices and support people far from the labour market

SHOWCASING OUR IMPACT

In 2024, we hosted the second **OECD Local Skills Week**, an international conference on developing local skills policies and preparing the workforce for the green-digital twin transition. It brought together institutional partners, governments and participants from **92 countries and 480 cities** featuring **more than 60 speakers**.

More than 30 cities and regions around the world have benefited from our tailor-made reviews on **local job creation**, which deliver evidence-based and practical recommendations on how to better support employment and economic development at the local level.



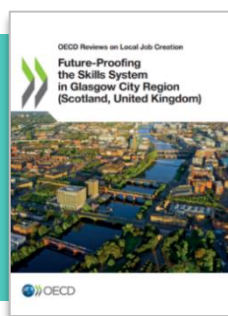
OUR RESOURCES



Job Creation and Local Economic Development 2023: Bridging the Great Green Divide



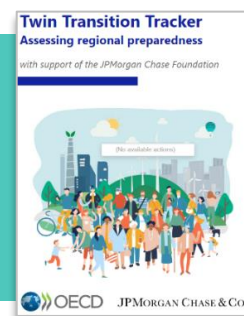
TAILORED GUIDANCE



Future-proofing the Skills System in the Glasgow City Region (Scotland, United Kingdom)



DATA



Twin Transition Tracker: Assessing regional preparedness



For more information

→ <https://oe.cd/local-employment-and-skills>



Social economy and innovation

Unleashing its full potential to create economic and social value



The social economy and social innovation are at the forefront of tackling pressing socio-economic and environmental challenges while creating jobs with social impact. They help find innovative solutions for underserved groups and places as well as local development more broadly in the ongoing green-digital twin transition. By championing an equitable distribution of benefits, participative governance and innovative business models, the social economy seeks to positively transform local communities and is active across sectors such as agriculture, banking, care, healthcare, education, housing, energy and community development.

The OECD helps governments at all levels develop and implement effective strategies to promote the social economy and foster social innovation. Governments can set helpful legal frameworks, reinforce access to finance and procurement, and promote business development services, among many other tools. They can also raise awareness of its positive impact, whether it be to help transition people into formal employment, bring about innovative solutions such as a platform co-operative, or contribute to a circular economy.

WHAT WE DO

Deliver tailored policy advice and guide reforms

- Work with governments to assess how their policies can do more to develop their social economy ecosystem

- Develop policy guides and toolkits on creating the right conditions for the social economy to flourish

- Support efforts to use social innovations to improve policy outcomes

Gather innovative data and evidence

- Carry out thematic reviews of the social economy and its contribution to supporting places and people, including women, youth, and refugees

- Collect and analyse data on the state of the social economy in its different forms and contexts

- Advise policy makers and practitioners on how to measure social impact and quantify the many tangible benefits for people and places

Build communities of practice

- Organise capacity building events for policy makers and practitioners in the social economy using the Better Entrepreneurship Policy Tool

- Disseminate case studies and compendiums of good practice to showcase the contributions of the social economy to policy priorities

- Gather experts and policy makers to discuss how to use and implement the OECD Recommendation on the Social and Solidarity Economy and Social Innovation

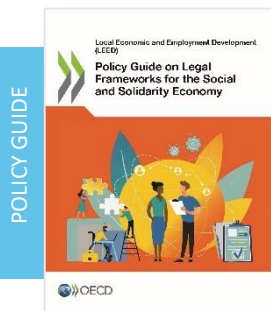
SHOWCASING OUR IMPACT

The findings of our in-depth policy review, “Boosting Social Entrepreneurship and Social Enterprise Development in Ireland” **directly informed the development of Ireland’s National Social Enterprise Policy**. The government of Ireland also formally adopted a definition of ‘social enterprise’ that expressly aligns with the OECD definition.

LEED has produced globally recognised policy guides, over 30 country fact sheets and **more than 20 in-depth reviews on the state of the social economy** across many countries and regions of the OECD, including in Brandenburg (Germany), Czechia, Estonia, Ireland, Lithuania, the Netherlands, and Slovenia, among many others.



OUR RESOURCES



Legal Frameworks for the Social and Solidarity Economy



Insights from social and solidarity economy data: An international perspective



The OECD Recommendation on the Social and Solidarity Economy and Social Innovation



For more information

→ <https://oe.cd/social-economy-and-social-innovation>



Culture, creative sectors and global events

Strengthening the benefits for local development



Cultural and creative sectors are a significant but often overlooked source of jobs, income and innovation. Cultural and creative employment accounts for up to 1 in 20 jobs in some OECD countries, and up to 1 in 10 jobs in major cities. They offer significant social benefits, from supporting health and well-being, to promoting the inclusion of marginalised groups. Cultural and creative spaces can also help revitalise city centres and main streets.

This is why the OECD works with national and local authorities to shape evidence-based policies to promote thriving cultural and creative sectors, measure their social and economic impact and mainstream culture into wider policy agendas. Major cultural, business and sporting global events such as the Olympic and Paralympic Games, World Expos or Capitals of Culture offer unique opportunities to create lasting, positive legacies for cities and regions. However, these positive legacies have to be planned from the start.

WHAT WE DO



Deliver tailored policy advice and guide reforms

Team up with national, regional and local policy makers to maximise the economic and social impact of your creative economy

Boost the capacity of governments to integrate culture into broader economic and social development strategies

Empower regions and cities with the tools to leverage large-scale events as catalysts for local development



Gather innovative data and evidence

Gather critical data and evidence to build a complete picture of cultural and creative sectors in your country, region or city

Improve the quality of internationally comparable statistics and evidence on the scale and impact of culture and creative sectors, including for global fora such as G20

Share the latest methods to measure the impact and legacy of major events, such as the Olympic and Paralympic Games



Build communities of practice

Discuss the latest practices in hot topics in cultural and creative sectors through our Summer Academy on Cultural and Creative Industries and other events

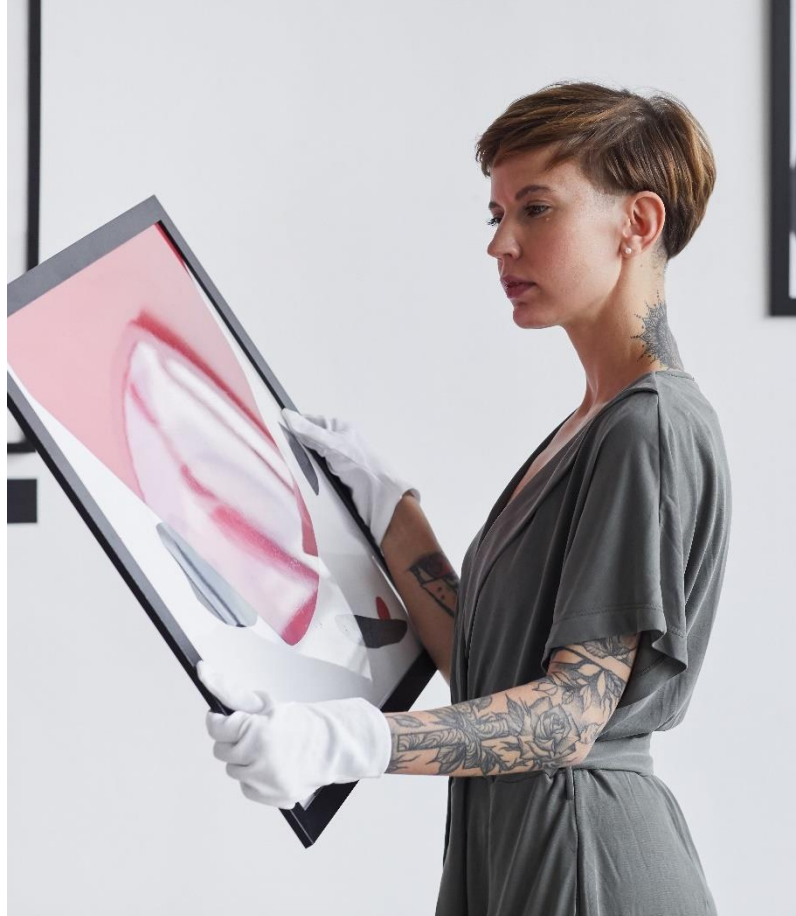
Convene experts on statistics in the cultural and creative sectors to advance the global state of knowledge

Discuss with peers how to implement the OECD Recommendation on Global Events and Local Development

SHOWCASING OUR IMPACT

Our two standard-setting OECD Guides on measuring the social, economic and environmental impacts of major events are driving real and lasting change in the way that major events – including the Olympic Games – are imagined and organised.

The **Paris 2024 Organising Committee incorporated our guidance** into their evaluation strategy – and from 2030 onwards, all Olympic and Paralympic Games hosts will be contractually obliged to follow the OECD Guides in designing their impact and legacy strategy.



OUR RESOURCES



Culture and Local Development: A Guide for Local Governments, Communities and Museums



The Culture Fix: Creative People, Places and Industries



Culture and the Creative Economy in Colombia: Leveraging the Orange Economy



For more information

→ <https://oe.cd/culture-creative-industries-and-sports>



Local economic development

Cultivating place transformation and entrepreneurship



Building inclusive pathways for local entrepreneurship and economic and social transformation in struggling communities remains a challenge. Addressing existing geographic divides and crafting "future-proof" policies in the era of green and digital transitions demands a departure from business as usual.

Local industrial policy and major investment packages are also offering new opportunities in many places. Programmes to revitalise main streets are another tool to support local community dynamism. Novel approaches are also needed to build on the assets of all communities, from building capacities for local leadership to better leveraging local social capital. Through initiatives such as the Transforming Places project and the work on inclusive entrepreneurship, the OECD is helping to unleash the social and economic benefits of place transformation and different forms of entrepreneurship to get there.

WHAT WE DO

Deliver tailored policy advice to guide reforms

Help governments analyse and improve their policies to close the gaps in entrepreneurship, for women, youth, seniors, migrants and other groups

Identify strategies for governments to support place transformation through in-depth case studies

Explore in-depth specific sectors that can help place transformation and dynamism, such as main street retail

Gather innovative data and evidence

Undertake novel research on understudied dimensions of local transformation, including the role of social capital and local leaders in spearheading change

Identify the ingredients for successful place transformation based on international case studies and lessons from the past

Analyse the data to understand how future transitions will be shaped by megatrends such as the green and digital transition, AI, and demographic change

Build communities of practice

Gather global experts on place transformation to inform OECD policy recommendations

Bring together youth entrepreneurs to learn new strategies through the Youth Entrepreneurship Policy Academy

SHOWCASING OUR IMPACT

Our Youth Entrepreneurship Policy Academy (YEPA), managed in collaboration with the European Commission, is a **peer-learning network of more than 150 participants, including policy makers, youth and social entrepreneurship networks, and researchers.**

Through webinars, workshops and digital resources, the Academy has raised awareness across the OECD of common barriers to youth entrepreneurship, while promoting policy-based solutions.



OUR RESOURCES

ANALYSIS



The Missing Entrepreneurs



ANALYSIS



Transforming Places Project



POLICY TOOL



The Better Entrepreneurship Policy Tool



For more information

→ <https://oe.cd/transforming-places>

→ <https://oe.cd/inclusive-entrepreneurship>



The OECD Trento Centre for Local Development

Building capacities and testing new ideas for local development



The OECD Trento Centre for Local Development, located in Northeast Italy, was created over 20 years ago to support innovations in local development and to showcase local examples for a global audience. It provides innovative approaches to capacity building, with numerous summer and winter academies on topics such as smart specialisation, culture and creative sectors or local development in Latin America.

It serves as a “living lab” to test new ideas, from teleworking strategies to boosting the social economy. It also hosts the Spatial Productivity Lab that provides cutting-edge research on the drivers of productivity growth as well as online seminars on related topics with world-leading academics. The Trento Centre is supported by the Autonomous Province of Trento (Italy) and the Autonomous Region of Trentino-Alto Adige/ Südtirol (Italy).

WHAT WE DO

Deliver tailored policy advice and guide reforms

Provide regions with granular data analysis and develop evidence-based strategies to harness the potential of AI, remote work and digitalisation with a spatial lens

Accompany cities and regions to improve policies to retain and attract talent and enhance their smart specialisation strategy

Gather innovative data and evidence

Host the Spatial Productivity Lab, an innovative research laboratory that generates and disseminates ground-breaking research and insights on the local drivers of productivity growth

Partner with national and subnational governments to understand what policies work where, and learn how to build ex-ante evaluation mechanisms into new policies

Build communities of practice

Empower local leaders and practitioners through capacity building programmes featuring workshops and seminars that transform OECD-wide knowledge into actionable strategies

Gather policy makers and practitioners from around the world at summer and winter academies to learn and share from concrete examples and field visits to inspiring local initiatives

SHOWCASING OUR IMPACT

Since the Trento Centre was founded in 2003, we have organised more than **600 capacity building seminars and events**, including conferences, workshops, and study visits. More than **32 000 regional development policy makers and practitioners from 105 countries** have benefited from our capacity building activities. We have produced more than **120 policy reviews, studies, guides and manuals** to assist policy makers and practitioners around the world.



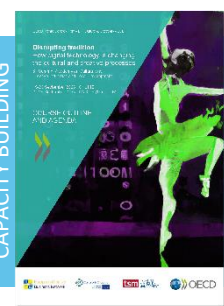
OUR RESOURCES



Bringing Trentino's productivity growth back on track: A comparison with OECD "peer" regions



Unlocking the potential of teleworking to address labour shortages in the Ems-Achse, Germany



Summer Academy on Cultural and Creative Industries and Local Development



For more information

→ <https://www.trento.oecd.org>



The OECD Local Development Forum

Bridging ministries and main streets

Created in 2004, the OECD Local Development Forum is a global community of thousands of policy makers and practitioners from networks of regional and national governments, employment and training agencies, local development agencies, chambers of commerce, social innovators, businesses and social economy organisations. They are united by a shared commitment to making their communities more resilient, inclusive and sustainable.

The Forum hosts an in-person conference and numerous webinars and workshops throughout the year on trending topics such as green jobs, reviving high streets and new approaches to local economic development, such as community wealth building. The Forum Board and partners – which include representatives from the LEED Directing Committee, as well as local and regional government associations and practitioner networks – help to set the Forum agenda.



WHAT WE DO

Foster peer learning and exchange

Provide a dynamic platform, both online and in person, for peer learning and exchange among policy makers and practitioners

Convene a global conversation: our annual conference brings together members and thought leaders to share solutions for building resilient and inclusive communities

Shape the debate on local development

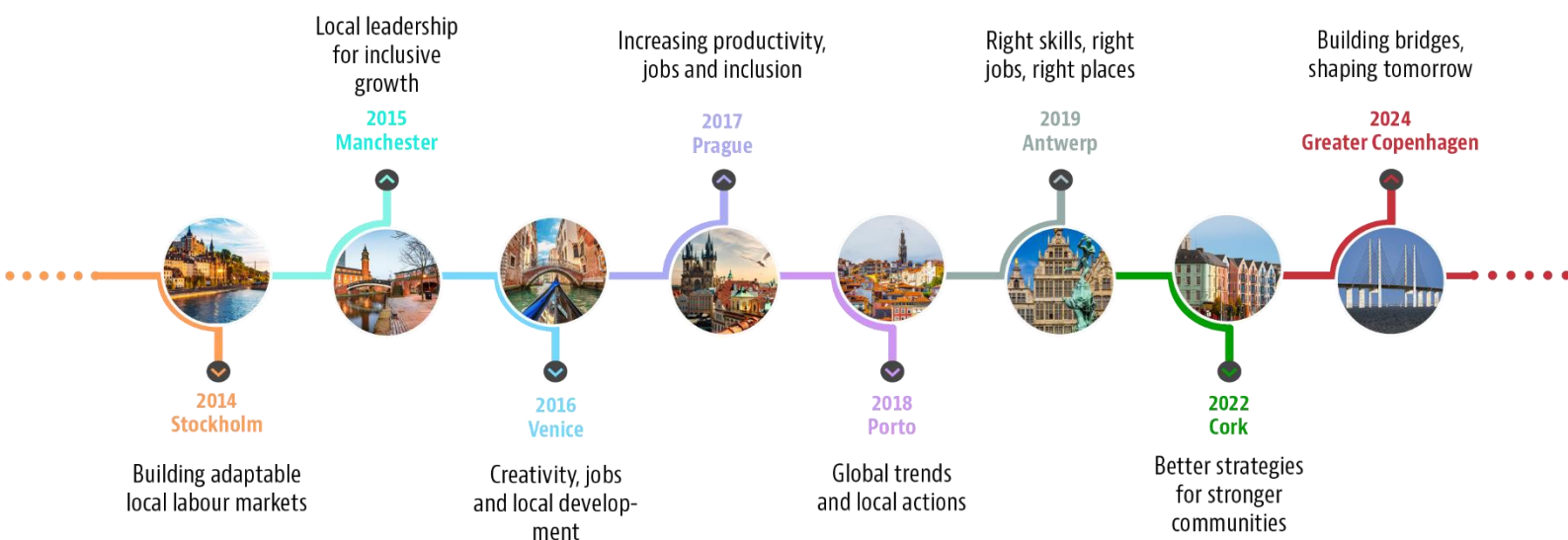
Organise workshops and webinars to tackle trending pertinent topics on local development, such as reviving main streets, place-based policies, and green jobs and skills

Build a two-way street between the OECD and local communities, bringing the latest OECD research beyond ministries to local communities, while ensuring that local voices inform our work

Disseminate local innovations and best practices

Host the digital PLACES Portal, a virtual hub for local policy makers and practitioners to share great examples of innovative solutions that are building sustainable and inclusive communities

OUR ANNUAL FORUM MEETINGS



HOW TO GET INVOLVED

Join as a Forum partner

Becoming a Forum Partner allows you to help steer the direction of the work, tap into an international network and gain global visibility. National, regional and local governments, associations, civic society organisations, and firms – from large corporations to small start-ups – are all welcome to join.

Host the annual conference

Hosting the annual conference is a unique opportunity to showcase your city/region to hundreds of policy makers and practitioners from across the world, boost your international profile, and shape the debate on local development.

Host a workshop or side event

Host a Forum workshop to go in-depth on specific topics, while building your networks and international exposure in the process.

JOIN THE GLOBAL CONVERSATION

Sign up for our newsletter to stay up to date on the latest in-person and virtual activities



For more information

→ <https://oe.cd/LDF>

Contact the LEED management team

The LEED Secretariat, housed in the Centre for Entrepreneurship, SMEs, Regions and Cities, has an international staff working out of the OECD's headquarters in Paris as well as the OECD Trento Centre for Local Development in Italy. With backgrounds in economics, policy analysis, and statistics, and experience in national and local public administrations, the private sector and the social economy, we bring a multidisciplinary and practical perspective to all our work.



Lamia Kamal-Chaoui

Director, OECD Centre for
Entrepreneurship, SMEs, Regions and Cities
Lamia.KAMAL-CHAOUI@oecd.org



Nadim Ahmad

Deputy Director, OECD Centre for
Entrepreneurship, SMEs, Regions and Cities
Nadim.AHMAD@oecd.org



Karen Maguire

Head of Division, Local Employment and
Economic Development Programme
Karen.MAGUIRE@oecd.org



Lukas Kleine-Rueschkamp

Head of Unit,
Local Employment and Skills
Lukas.KLEINE-RUESCHKAMP@oecd.org



Amal Chevreau

Head of Unit,
Social Economy and Innovation
Amal.CHEVREAU@oecd.org



Ekaterina Travkina

Coordinator, Culture, Creative Industries
and Local Development
Ekaterina.TRAVKINA@oecd.org



Alessandra Proto

Head of Trento Centre for Local Development
Alessandra.PROTO@oecd.org



Anna Rubin

Manager, Local Development Forum
Anna.RUBIN@oecd.org

About the OECD

The OECD is a multidisciplinary intergovernmental organisation of 38 member countries which engages in its work an increasing number of non-members from all regions of the world. The Organisation's core mission today is to help governments work together towards a stronger, cleaner, fairer global economy. Through its network of 250 specialised committees and working groups, the OECD provides a setting where governments compare policy experiences, seek answers to common problems, identify good practice, and co-ordinate domestic and international policies. Find out more: www.oecd.org.

About the Centre for Entrepreneurship, SMEs, Regions and Cities

The Centre helps local, regional and national governments unleash the potential of entrepreneurs and small and medium-sized enterprises, promote inclusive and sustainable regions and cities, boost local job creation and implement sound tourism policies. Find out more: www.oecd.org/cfe



www.oecd.org/cfe/leed

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